

R. Ray Barnes

The Art of Poetry

Volume 1

Thoughts Dancing From Heart To Mind



The Art Of Poetry: Thoughts Dancing From Heart To Mind

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Volume 1

Thoughts Dancing From Heart To Mind

By R. Ray Barnes



R. Ray Barnes Productions

R. Ray Barnes

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**THE ART OF POETRY
VOLUME 1
THOUGHTS DANCING FROM HEART TO MIND**

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The Power Of Uniting In Love

When you inner-connect spiritually with that special someone, that special “true love,” your “soul mate,” the energy created from this spiritual union of love gives birth to a oneness that transforms you and your mate into a single more dynamic source for love and manifestation of love, much greater than either of you could be alone, whose capacity for and capability to love increases exponentially. When this occurs, by virtue of the power and impact inherent in such a fusion of love, it will become the most important occurrence in your life—and could very well be the closest thing you’ll ever experience that mirror and reflects the “first love” that the creator had for humankind.



R. Ray Barnes

Acknowledgments

*To all the
persons, places, and things that have
touched my life and given me inspiration...*

*Especially to
my dear wife Diane and my family:
Damon, Christopher, Jordan, Damon Ray, LaDraya, EJ,
Brianna and Isaiah for loving me despite my imperfections.*

*To my parents,
Robert and Yvonne Barnes,
these thoughts are merely an extension of the
love and wisdom
that you've given to me.
I love and thank you with all my heart.
May you rest eternally in peace forever together...*

Dedication

To all those who seek true love...

You must always remember and never forget---that you are more than what meets the eye. The essence of your beauty lies within. So don't be afraid to look deep inside to explore the full expanse of your heart and inner soul.

If you dare to undertake the journey, you will find there a boundless treasure of love and great gifts of understanding, patience and trust just waiting for you to discover and claim...

You may have visited your inner essence before at midnight in your dreams and didn't remember its existence.

However, to realize your treasures and receive your wonderful gifts, you must venture there at midday with your subconscious mind wide open to the fullness of the creator's bright light so that you may clearly envision the vast riches that were bequeathed to you.

Once accomplished, if you then share the treasures of that knowledge and understanding wisely, your heart shall be filled with enough love, peace, joy, and happiness to last forever...

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R. Ray Barnes

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Volume 1

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A Friend

Being

A Friend

means

sharing

Your Heart

with others...

and

I'm so glad

that

You

sh-are

the biggest

piece

of

My Heart

A Musical Dance Of Love

Oh, how you
Touch me, Caress me,
*and **Fill me up***
*with the **Sweet Taste** of your **Love**—*
*Such a **Wonderful Spirit** you are...*
*a **Bright Light** shining through me,*
*illuminating the deep **dark** corners*
*of my **Love Starved Soul**.*
I Thank God for your Light of Love—
Like the warm early morning sun,
a misty afternoon shower,
and a sensuous moonlit night,
***I Feel** you energizing and nourishing me,*
Fulfilling** my **Need for Romance,
Feeding** my **Hunger** and **Quenching
*my **Thirst** for **Love,***
*and my **Desire** to be **Loved**...*
*You've **Choreographed** in me*
*a new **Dance of Life,***
***Reborn** as*
*a **Waltz** of **Love,** a **Ballet** of **Joy,** a **Salsa** of **Pleasure,***
*a **Tango** of **Growth,** a **Modern Miracle** of **Trust,***
*as you so **Rhythmically** and so softly*
***Tapped** your way into my heart...*

Now, whenever
*I Feel the **Music of Love Dancing** inside of me,*
*it's your sweet **Melody**,*
*your kind **Heart**,*
*your loving **Soul**,*
and
*your giving **Spirit***
*blending together in such beautiful **Harmony***
that comes to mind—
because it's your
Musical Dance Of Love
that makes my
Heart Beat



All That Jazz

(Dedicated to the memory of Robert "Bobby" Barnes)

*I love that **Jazz**...cause **Jazz** is **All That!**
And makin' you shake yo' ass is not **All** that **Jazz** is.*

***Jazz** is **Smooth**...*

*And it soothes when it **Serenades** you
with an unrehearsed hypnotic **Verse**,
and in a sweet but vociferous **Voice**,*

Jazz Sings** and **Swings

*sensuous, heartfelt **Melodies** of love
that makes your **Spirit** rejoice.*

***Jazz** seeps into all the deep dark crevices
of hidden emotions that are tucked away
in the folds of your **Heart** and **Soul**...*

*I love that **Jazz**...cause **Jazz** is **All That!**
And makin' you shake yo' ass is not **All** that **Jazz** is.*

***Jazz** is **Hot**...*

Like sunlight, its energy is always aglow...

*You might wanna seek some shade
and some ice-cold of lemonade*

*as its **Rhythms** move through you like a hot lava flow...*

*Yeah, that **Jazz** is always on the go, headlining the **Show**,
that's why I keep my cooler of ice in tow.*

Shit! I ain't gotta tell you,

cause if you listen to **Jazz** then you already know.
Jazz's light will energize your chi and heat yo' ass up,
sometimes makin' you sweat, whisperin' under your breath,
"God damn **Jazz**, what the fuck...!"

I love that **Jazz**...cause **Jazz** is **All That!**
And makin' you shake yo' ass is not **All** that **Jazz** is.
Jazz is **Unpredictable**...

Sometimes it makes you wanna holler
stomp yo' feet and clap yo' hands
while you **Move** and **Groove** to the band...
And then, just like that as a matter of fact!
it'll change the **Tempo** on yo' ass,
completely transforming the **Mood** from **Slow** to **Fast**,
with no explanations, recantations, or justifications,
just **Improvisation**...

Jazz unconventionally, extemporaneously,
Artistically with such dexterity
relates and articulates
Words of Wisdom and **Lessons of Love**
all over your being, around your essence,
and all throughout your **Soul**,
then it'll say, "Oh, maybe I bettah slow my roll...
Was the beat movin' to fast fo' yo' ass?
That's because I repositioned and transitioned to
Avant-Garde Jazz."

*That's why
I love that **Jazz**...cause **Jazz** is **All That!**
And makin' you shake yo' ass is not **All** that **Jazz** is.
So, I have to mention that you must pay attention
to **Jazz's Ascension**,
cause like **Bird**, **Jazz** flies high,
and like **Trane**, **Jazz** swiftly rides by,
makin' you **Dizzy** puttin' your heart in a tizzy...
But after **Miles** and miles of keepin' you movin' and busy
with a more fluent style,
Jazz will still give you **Miles of Smiles**
takin' you **Seven Steps** closer to **Heaven** for a little while...*

*You see,
I love that **Jazz**...cause **Jazz** is **All That!**
And makin' you shake yo' ass is not **All** that **Jazz** is.
Jazz is **Spontaneous**...
Unanticipated and syncopated,
hotly debated and often imitated,
and sometimes **Jazz** is so sexy it's **X-rated!**
But I'm just so elated that I'm related and share in
Jazz's African Rhythmic Roots,
thus, allowing me to benefit from the **Harmony**
and sweetness of **Jazz's Lyrical** fruits—
Jazz is so resolute!
And when it's in the **Groove**,*

*it'll make your **Knees Bop**
and your **Hips Hop** as you **Move**.
Jazz ain't too hot to trot, nor is it too cold to hold,
but it is too cool to be fooled.
That's why **Jazz** is a **Standard Musical** rule.*

*I love that **Jazz**...cause **Jazz** is **All That!**
And makin' you shake yo' ass is not **All** that **Jazz** is.
Jazz is **Sweet**...*

*Never takes a backseat and just loves to compete.
Jazz has a knack to attack the **Beat**,
yet, can still retreat intact,
and just layback and interact...
But you see, like I said, **Jazz** is **All That!***

*But before I go any further wit' my list of **Jazz's** trysts,
I insist that I cease and desist take a break and stop!
Cause **Jazz** puts me in such a state of elation
I feel heart palpitations puttin' me in cardiogenic shock...
Jazz will give you the **Blues**, **Funk** you up, **Rock** yo' body,
put pride in yo' stride, a hump in yo' rump,
pump you up and make yo' ass jump!
You see, it's so much to **Jazz's** story plot
it's easier for me to talk about what **Jazz** is not.
So, pardon me, cause I gotta pause...
talkin' 'bout **All This Jazz** is making me hot!*

*So, just gimme a minute to catch my breath
and I'll be right back in it
Johnny Hodges on the spot...*

*Okay, I'm back to reenlist, don't wanna be remiss,
But here's the twist, when it comes to talkin' 'bout **Jazz**
I just can't resist...*

*Sometimes **Jazz** sounds and feels so regal
you might think it to be illegal.*

*But I must admit, it does sound quite felonious
when played by **Thelonious**...*

*But you won't hear no **Funk** comin' from the **Monk**,
but maybe a one of a kind sweet melodic trick or treat
that takes an acquired taste to eat.*

*And thou it may be
a little surreptitious and difficult to digest
it's not fictitious or superstitious, it's original
and more delicious than the rest...*

*I love that **Jazz**...cause **Jazz** is **All That!**
And makin' you shake yo' ass is not **All** that **Jazz** is.
Jazz is **Chromatic**...*

*Emphatic and sometimes systematic,
but it's never in a panic,*

Jazz's Creed is **Taylor-made** for the romantic,
like the **Jazz Artists** who set sail on the **Atlantic**.

And like the real **McCoy Tyner**,
Jazz is often finer in its **Minor Mode**,
very **Instrumental**, **Melodically** fresh
and never too old,
Jazz is original, cain't be bought or sold...
and still savors its flavor
when it sails on a **Major Scale**,
always reaching for the horizon **Jazz** never fails,
it's simultaneously heads and tails.
Jazz often cruises **Solo** on the ocean **Blue**;
Note, though its destination may be remote,
Jazz always manages to stay afloat.

Jazz is sometimes emphatic,
Symphonic and **Diatonic**,
Living each moment **Augmented**,
Jazz has life everlasting and joy within it.
Thou sometimes **Diminished**,
Jazz is eternal and never finished.
Like the **Celestial** sun,
the light and energy from **Jazz** is life giving
and shines its **Rays** on everyone...

*So, now you see, that's why
I love that **Jazz**...cause **Jazz** is **All That!**
And makin' you shake yo' ass is not **All** that **Jazz** is...*



Illustration: uDiscoverMusic

Alphabet Love

I just L.O.V.E. love it when I'm lovin' U

U make me smile when I'm feelin' blue

One look N your eyes I see heaven too

Beauty seems the Beast when lyin' next to U

I just L.O.V.E. love it when I'm lovin' U

Never have to settle or just make do

True love just seems to B A part of U

An angel N disguise if U only knew

I just L.O.V.E. love it when I'm lovin' U

The sky seems bluer when I'm out with U

The sun looks like the moon shinin' next to U

I need Ray Ban's just to look @ U

I just L.O.V.E. love it when I'm lovin' U

U can change the weather with A breath or two

Cool Breezes feel humid when I'm close to U

Snowflakes just melt when they fall on U

I just L.O.V.E. love it when I'm lovin' U

The sun rises N sets based on what U do

The ocean's tides ebb N flow because of U

It's like A magic carpet ride rockin' N rollin' U

I just L.O.V.E. love it when I'm lovin' U

You're Queen of the Nile in my point of view

Drives me wild just to think of U

Makes me wanna holler makin' love to U

I just L.O.V.E. love it when I'm lovin' U

UR sizzlin' hot like A Barbeque

Sparks just fly high bouncin' off of U

Whoo-wee it's hot as hell up N-side of U

I just L.O.V.E. love it when I'm lovin' U

Fulfilling dreams, I guess is what U do

There is no shrew to B tamed N U

Just want U to B A-Dick-ted to my love N U

I just L.O.V.E. love it when I'm lovin' U

Hates to admit it but I know I do

Hurricanes stop when UR passin' through

Girl U know Mother Nature's gettin' fed up with U

I just L.O.V.E. love it when I'm lovin' U

I don't know much but I know that's true

Einstein's relativity is A distant cousin N A class with U

N Freud is A factoid compared to the psyche U do

I just L.O.V.E. love it when I'm lovin' U

U were just A fantasy hitherto

But here N now you've made my love anew

I owe my heart N soul due to lovin' U

I just L.O.V.E. love it when I'm lovin' U

Feels so good I don't know what to do

When I try to count I only get to 2

N can only recite the alphabet up to letter U

*See,
so, I guess it's **true***



*A.B.C.D.
I'm so N love with U!!!*

*Especially for **Diane***

Are We Children Of God?

It has been said that we are all children of God and made in His image and likeness. However, I say we are all a part of God, inseparable and indivisible. Therefore, we cannot be made in the image of God nor in any likeness of God---the image of God can never be pictured. Spirit, the main component of God cannot be seen. How does one depict spirit in an image or a picture? What does spirit look like? When you look in the mirror you can't see the air in between you and the reflection of you in the mirror. When you take a picture of a building or a flower out of doors, you see the subject but not the air in between the subject; nevertheless, the air is there. You can feel the air, be affected by the air, but you can't see the air; nevertheless, the air is there.

Likewise, you can feel spirit, be affected by spirit, yet you can't see spirit. God is like the universe, the further we investigate it the more we see. And God, like the universe, is ever expanding... When the whole of God can be pictured, or when the end of the universe is realized, life will cease to be. Our existence is a quest to find it's beginning, however, if we do find the beginning we will also discover that it was all an illusion---a dream of sorts. That's why spirit life is eternal because it has neither an identifiable beginning nor end. There never was a time when spirit was not!

The big bang is the butterfly of our universe, that which came before it may be totally unrecognizable to how it appears in the present. What

came before the butterfly was the caterpillar, which looked totally unrelated, and what came before that was the egg that produced that caterpillar and on and on and on... God and Spirit can never be created or destroyed, it has no beginning---it always was, is, and will always be.

God only relates to things that have a spirit. Matter, dark matter, anti-matter, light, physical energy and any such things relating to physics are governed by their own unique laws. God did not create all that is present in the universe; God came into being simultaneously along with all the physical matter that was created in the universe. God is comprised of our collective spirits and as such is here to govern the same. Not any one of us is God, however, we are a part of what makes up God. As the Milky Way Galaxy is not the universe, it's part of what makes up the universe. And like all the other bodies in the universe, the Milky Way Galaxy is governed by the same principals and laws of physics, all of which we don't understand. Likewise, we are all part of what makes up the body of God and are governed by the principals and laws of spirit, all of which we don't understand. There are various levels of how spirit and or God operate. There are basic levels that are very karma like, however, on more advanced levels, God and spirit operates liken to quantum mechanics of the physical realm; totally unpredictable.

In physics, energy has a clear mathematical definition and can be precisely quantified in established units. Psychic energy, on the other hand, has no formal definition, and cannot be measured in the same precise way. On the contrary, it is detected and assessed personally. It

is a felt experience. And the nature and intensity are subjective evaluations rather than objective measurements.

Well-established laws apply to physical energy. The total energy in a system is conserved; it cannot be created or destroyed. Psychic energy does not appear to obey any such laws. The 'energy' felt in a group of people has not come at the expense of 'energy' from another group of people or been taken from the 'good energy' of the painting on the wall. Quite the opposite, the 'energy' of the painting might have contributed to the 'energy' of the group.*

*The radiation of physical energy obeys an inverse square law. Double the distance from an object and the energy received is one quarter of what it was before. Ten times the distance and the energy decreases to one-hundredth.** Yet, medical intuitive seem to pick up the 'energy' of a person in another continent as easily as someone in the same room, and prayer appears to reach across equally vast distances with little attenuation in the effect. Whatever is happening is not obeying a basic law of physical energy.*

Since physical energy and psychic energy behave so differently, it is clear we are dealing with two totally distinct phenomena. So why do people claim that they are one in the same, or something closely allied?

* This statement is true; it describes the fundamental principle of the "Law of Conservation of Energy," which states that the total energy within a closed system

remains constant, meaning energy can only be transformed from one form to another, not created or destroyed.

** This statement means that if you double the distance from a source of radiation, the amount of energy received will be reduced to one-quarter of its original value, and if you increase the distance tenfold, the energy received will decrease to one-hundredth of its original value, because radiation intensity follows an inverse square law.

Beautiful—Just Perfect!

Have you ever seen the first light at sunrise?

Have you ever seen stars shining in dark skies?

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Have you ever seen a newborn baby at nap?

Have you ever seen mountains with a snowcap?

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Have you ever seen flowers in full bloom?

Have you ever seen spring showers in the afternoon?

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Have you ever seen wild horses in an all-out run?

Have you ever seen children running about having fun?

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Have you ever seen a bird of prey in-flight?

Have you ever seen owl's eyes glowing in the night?

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Have you ever seen two rainbows in the sky?

Have you ever seen a caterpillar become a butterfly?

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Have you ever seen a school of fish underwater?

Have you ever seen a flock of birds in perfect order?

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Have you ever seen the plains after a fresh snowfall?

Have you ever seen a giant redwood just standing tall?

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Have you ever seen the horizon at sunset?

Have you ever seen a waterfall close enough to get wet?

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Have you ever seen poetry in real motion?

Have you ever seen moonlight glistening on the ocean?

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

Beautiful—Isn't It Just Perfect!

There is so much beauty to see each day,

But sometimes I just look at you and say...

Beautiful—Isn't She Just Perfect!

Beautiful—Isn't She Just Perfect!

Compared To What?

We often hear people speaking of the fear of an angry God and whether they maybe going to heaven or hell after death...As is often said in religious circles, he or she may be “going up yonder” to a better place, or even worse, “burning in hell” down below.

We must remember, as Elbert Hubbard said, “We are not punished for our sins, but by them.”

Yet, when we move on from this Earthly realm our spirit will reside elsewhere, however, there will be no way to discern whether it will be a better or worse place than where we are now, as we will have no recollection from whence we came and therefore nothing to compare it to.

Better, is a very subjective term; better compared to whom, better compared to what?

Better, for those who are enlightened know very well that better is a state of mind, not a state of how much money you have, or how many things you possess.

There are many very wealthy people who have committed suicide, and monks who possess very little who live in total bliss.

It seems, when everyone is near the end of their Earthly life experience, close to death, or are about to pass away, the end seems to be quite the same regardless of stature, wealth, power, position, or fame. I've not heard of one corpse speak of how much better they have it over another corpse.

So now is the time to enjoy your life on this Earthly plane...because after we pass on our spirit will be on an entirely new journey and experience with no recollection of its Earthly past...

Cool Dancer

she called herself a

Cool Dancer...

but what does that really mean?

*does that mean she's no longer **Hot**?*

or does that mean she's a little

cold, icy, chilly, breezy kind-a-Cool?

or does that mean she's a

calm, serene, composed, unruffled kind-a-Cool?

or does that mean she's an

aloof, indifferent, non-emotional,

unenthusiastic kind-a-Cool?

or does that mean she's a

fashionable, sophisticated, fly,

All That Jazz kind-a-Cool?

or does that mean she's a

Lady Day, Sarah Vaughan,

Nina Simone, Diana Ross, Beyoncé kind-a-Cool?

or does that mean she's a

Sade, Anita Baker, Jill Scott

Erykah Badu, Cassandra Wilson, kind-a-Cool?

or does that mean she's an

Angela Davis, Ntozake Shange,

Dr. Frances Cress Welsing,

Nikki Giovanni kind-a-Cool?

or does that mean she's an

Isis, Nefertiti, Hatshepsut,

Nefertari kind-a-Cool?

or does that mean she's a

Dorothy Dandridge, Josephine Baker,

Lena Horne, Angela Bassett kind-a-Cool?

or does that mean she's a

Katherine Dunham, Pearl Primus,

Judith Jamison, Debbie Allen kind-a-Cool?

yeah, she called herself a

Cool Dancer...

that's what she said, but what does that really mean?

well, at this point, i don't really know,

but whatever

kind-a-Cool that she is---i'm Cool wit' it...



Cry You A River

There is a Love about you—

a Special Gift

That keeps giving and a love that keeps loving...

There is a Feeling about you—

*That **Touches** me so deeply,*

Massages my spirit and seems to never leave me...

There is Warmth about you—

*That **Eases** my heart, and soothes my soul,*

Yet, it sets aflame a desire within me

That burns to be with you, hold you, console you...

There is a Tenderness about you—

*That **Lives** in your eyes and resides in your smile,*

That keeps me looking at you, constantly,

From my mind's eye...

*You see **My Dear**,*

*Your **Love** is a **Special Gift***

*That **Touches** my spirit and **Warms** my heart*

*With such **Tenderness** it brings*

Tears of Joy to my Eyes...

And I'm hoping that from the continuous
Gift of your Love,
That I may
Cry You A River...



Damsel In Distress

*You are much like
A Beautiful Damsel In Distress
who's crying out
in the wilderness for help,
dying of hunger & thirst...
Then,
after several painful days
and many stressful nights
of searching and struggling desperately
to find you and
bring you nourishing juices,
fruits, berries, and nuts---
You
reject them,
instead wanting a Wine Cooler,
Potato Chips
Twinkies
and some Donuts...*

Divine Lady

*Carefully **God** furnished the skein
And bestowed upon it only her name
And as the Angels began to weave
The master uttered "careful please..."
Realizing something was special at hand
They meticulously followed the **Master's** plan
Over and over so diligently
They worked every part masterfully
Leaving only one part incomplete
As **God** took **His** Spirit and placed at her feet...
Taking **His Spirit** into her heart
I've seen her tear her life apart
Loving and giving more than her share
Loves virtue follows her everywhere
From everywhere to everyone she gives so free
Right to my heart she gave to me
Yes! she fulfilled the prophecy
Divinely*

Every Body Dies

*In
time
Every
Body
Dies...*

*our task
is to be not
Dead
in
Mind & Spirit
while our
Bodies
are still
Still Living...*

Free Love

*If you're seeking to have
Love in your **Life**,
stop searching all around trying to find it,
you already have more
Love
than you need...
The **Love**
you seek is imprisoned deep within your
Soul
just yearning to be set **Free**...*



*If you
Free the Love
you have **Within**,
you'll never be **Without Love***

From Here 2 There

*I'm **Here** missing you—*

*You're **There**...*

*I'm **Here** wanting you—*

*You're **There**...*

*I'm **Here** needing you—*

*You're **There**...*

*I'm **Here**—*

But,

*You're **There**...*

So,

Where can I go?

Who can I see?

What can I do?

...to get

My Love

From Here 2 There?

God Seems To Have Cancer

The statement, “There but for the grace of God go I,” seems to suggest that God did not bestow His grace on those people whom the statement is referring to. We must understand that ‘those people’ who are seen as lacking God’s grace are the like same as those who are making the statement seeming to believe that they are the benefactors of God’s grace. Those who believe they are the benefactors must realize that we are all part of the “one” body of God. In fact, we are all cells in the body of God, and if those who lack the blessings of grace suffer, then those who believe that they have received God’s grace suffer as well.

Because of physical distance, time and the space between the so-called grace benefactors, they see themselves as unconnected to those who lack the gift of grace and do not recognize the oneness of us all. They do not realize that in spirit, (which is truly the everlasting realm in which we all exist, the body is like a butterfly in its caterpillar state and our spirit is the butterfly) there are no distances between us—and we all stand side-by-side, yet flying free like the butterfly, but inner-connected and inner-dependent. Labeling someone as having grace and others as absent of grace creates a false barrier between them, making them believe that the two are somehow separate and not one.

It would be as if lung or breast cancer cells within our own bodies were causing us to suffer and the cells in our feet were saying, “There but for the grace of God go I,” not realizing that they too, are a part of the same

body, and if the cancer cells in the breast or lungs (seemingly far away from the feet) are neglected and left untreated and causes the body to die, the cells in the feet and cells throughout the other parts of the body would suffer the same fate and die as well!

In other words, collectively, our minds, bodies, and spirits are the “cells” that make up the body of God—inseparable and indivisible. Even though the cells in our physical bodies do not all look alike nor function the same, they must all work in harmony with each other for our bodies to live, thrive and survive—disharmony means death. Disharmony is dis-ease, dis-ease is disease, disease is cancer, and cancer can be defined as the body’s cells in disharmony; and cancer left neglected means death to the body. We as cells in the body of God must learn to work together in harmony or God will die!

We human beings, (homo sapiens sapiens) which are the cells that comprise the body of God, are in complete disarray, and if we desire to survive must learn to work together in harmony for God to live—though at this moment—God Seems To Have Cancer...

Maybe it should be more aptly stated that, “For those who suffer the lack of God’s grace there go we all.”

Heart 2 Heart

Imagine me lying next to you,

Heart 2 Heart

*With our **Spirits** entwined,*

*So close that you can feel my **Heartbeat**,*

*So near I can feel your **Heart** touching mine...*

*As one, our **Hearts** beat together,*

*In **Harmony** with the **Angels** above,*

*As **Peace** sings our **Melody***

and

***Joy** becomes our **Rhythm**,*

***God** orchestrates our **Symphony of Love**...*

*We listen closely being touched by our **Love** song,*

We hold each other tight as we begin to dance,

*A **Tango of Happiness** under the moonlight,*

As we step softly into our dreams of romance...

We are awakened at dawn

*by a **Love Goddess**,*

Shining her Rays of Light

into our

***Hearts and Minds**,*

R. Ray Barnes

Comfortable knowing that what

Love

God has joined 2-gether,

shall remain

Heart 2 Heart

for all time...



His-Story

I've grown tired of just

Hearing

His-tory...

so, from now on I'm

Telling

My-Story

Heartbeats...

I'm listening to

My Heartbeat—

And trying to hear yours...

*It's not easy to hear one's **Heartbeat** through fiber optics—*

such tricks, like playing pick-up sticks...

But I won't relent until time is spent

*with my **heart beating** next to yours*

*and your **heart beating** next to mine...*



So,

I'll keep listening to

My Heartbeat—

And trying to hear yours...

Hoping that in time, in like kind we may find

Love in our Hearts

*as well as our **Minds...***

How Sweet It Is

If the
Sweetness
that is in
Your Heart
is the same
as that which is upon
Your Lips...

Then
Your Love
shall forever
Taste of Honey
and the
Joys in Your Life
shall be more abundant
than crystals of
Pure Cane Sugar

I Love You Today

*No matter how tensed or how storied our past
No matter how slow we loved or how fast
No matter how long they said we'd last
No matter how we remained steadfast
If we are ever torn apart
And are forced to make a new start
Always know deep in your heart
More than who, what, where or how
Just know that*

I Love You Now

*Life can change at the blink of an eye
Without rhyme, reason or why
This moment is all on which we can rely
So, if things don't go our way
Please know that*

I Love You Today

*No matter how our story is told
No matter what our future holds
No matter all the glitter and gold
No matter how this dream unfolds
Destiny may change our fate yet again
And to all one day will come an end*

So, when our love rest riding on the wind

More than who, what, where or how

Just know that

I Love You Now

If life's changes cause us to rearrange

With no more love left to be claimed

And as lovers we become strange

And there's nothing more for us to say

Please know that

I Love You Today...

Just know that

I Love You Today

I Miss You

*Though the seasons have changed
the sad times seem to stay,
such lonely days have come
since you've gone away...*

*Though the sun is shining bright
and summer is near,
my heart is cold inside,
dark and full of fear...*

*I get lost inside of nowhere
and can't find myself when I'm here,
My eyes water at the thought of you
and I can't hold back the tears—*

I Miss You

*Words often come to mind
but I can't figure out what to say.*

*I try to reach for you,
but like my joy you slip away...*

*And now when I call your name
you never come, it's not the same,
who do I blame,*

or is it just love playing silly games?

*Your old emails read well
but something was missing; now I can tell...*

*If you were my better half,
then what does that make me now?
I keep telling myself, "I will survive,"
though I'm not quite sure how...
Or is that just a cliché
when there are no more prayers left to say—?*

I Miss You

*So, tell me, how could this be
when we fit together so perfectly?
I guess there's no infinite voyage
when you're lost at sea...
Maybe it just wasn't meant to be
that eternal love for you and me?
I thought the pain would end
and we'd go on happily as friends,
yet the grief is still here
while our love has disappeared...
I've been trying to get over you
and with no words left to say,
I tried holding you,
but like snowflakes you melted away...
So, I hold tight to our memories
hoping inside you'd stay,
while I cry myself to sleep at night
and re-live my nightmares during the day—*

I Miss You

I Still Hang-On To You

When I hang-up from you,

I Still Hang-On To You...

On to your Laughter

On to your Smile

On to your Touch

On to your Love—

When I hang-up from you,

I Still Hang-On To You...

On to your Joy

On to your Kindness

On to your Peace

On to your Love—

When I hang-up from you,

I Still Hang-On To You...

On to your Heart

On to your Soul

On to your Spirit

On to your Love—

When I hang-up from you,

I Still Hang-On To You...

I still hang-on to, I still hang-on, I still hang, I still, I—

I Still Hang-On To Your Love...

If The Shoe Fits

*The **Shoe***

you wear is a fitting thing...

so,

If The Shoe Fits

wear it

and

walk in style...

cause if

*The **Shoe***

doesn't fit

it's gonna hurt

*Your **Feet***

*Your **Heart***

*Your **Mind***

*Your **Body***

*Your **Soul***

*Your **Spirit***

&

Everything

Else

In A Very Special Way

*As I awake and look into the mirror,
I see a reflection of me...
Handsome and profound,
More powerful than a locomotive,
Able to leap tall buildings in a single bound.
Yes, here I stand a **Superman!**
Though super as I am, damn,
Sometimes I've struggled to keep pace,
But it's because of what you've instilled in me
That I've been able to remain in the race...*

*But as I stepped aside from my reflection,
After some introspection,
I saw you inside, smiling, holding me up
And pushing me along...
Catapulting me into the world,
Being the melody and lyrics to **My Life's** song.
So, at night before I go to sleep,
I pray and ask **You** my soul to keep.
Because I know in all my dreams there's the reality,
That if not for your sacrifice and love,
I could never be free to be me...*

*On this occasion of your **72nd Birthday**,
I just want to say,*

The Art Of Poetry: Thoughts Dancing From Heart To Mind

*I Love You Mom
In A Very Special Way...
Your #1 Son*

September 28, 2005

In Spite Of

I've often wondered...

If I Couldn't See

*the beauty and brightness
of your lovely **Smile**,*

Would I still love you?

If I Couldn't Hear

*the passionate and affectionate sound
of your sensuous **Voice**,*

Would I still love you?

If I Couldn't Feel

*the warmth and softness
of your gentle **Touch**,*

Would I still love you?

If I Couldn't Taste

*the sweetness of your honey-laced
syrupy flavored **Kiss**,*

Would I still love you?

If I Couldn't Smell

*the perfumed fragrance that just seems to ooze from your pores filling
the atmosphere with your aromatic **Scent**,*

Would I still love you?

Yes, I've often wondered...

If I Couldn't

See, Hear, Feel, Taste or Smell You,

Would I still love you?

But upon second thought, there is no need to wonder...

The answer is easy,

I love you

from the

Inside Out, not from the Outside In

and

I love you

In Spite of, not just Because of...

Indescribable

*As I was venturing along my path in **Life**
I saw with my own eyes a **Beautiful Rose**...*

*And I was **Blessed***

*To come close enough to envelop it into the folds of both my hands as I
brought my face nearer to its petals
to experience
the wonders of its **Heavenly Bouquet**—
and the **Fragrance** was
Indescribable...*

*As I was venturing along my path in **Life**
I saw with my own eyes a **Beautiful Nightingale**...*

*And I was **Blessed***

*To come close enough to the tree where it was perched and held my
head high into the air so I could place my ears as near as possible to it
to experience
the wonders of its **Heavenly Melody**—
and its **Music** was
Indescribable...*

*As I was venturing along my path in **Life**
I saw with my own eyes a **Beautiful Chinchilla***

*And I was **Blessed***

To come close enough to it in the mountains of Peru to hold it in my

*arms as I touched its soft and silky fur
to experience
the wonders of its **Heavenly Feel**—
and the **Texture** was
Indescribable...*

*As I was venturing along my path in **Life**
I saw with my own eyes a **Beautiful Black Cherry**
And I was **Blessed**
To come close enough to pluck it from the tree as I slowly brought it
forth into to my mouth
to experience
the wonders of its **Heavenly Flavor**—
the **Taste** of which was
Indescribable...*

*As I was venturing along my path in **Life**
I saw with my own eyes a **Beautiful Woman**
And I was **Blessed**
To come close enough to be surrounded by **Her** kind and gentle spirit
as she so graciously embraced my heart and caressed my soul as I
brought my light nearer to **Her** light to experience
the wonders of **Her Heavenly Love**—
and the **Sight**, the **Aroma**, the **Sound**,
the **Touch**, and the **Taste** of **Her** is*

Indescribable...

Is Your Property Condemned?

Our

Physical Bodies

are

temporary residences leased by

Our

Spirit,

in which we act as

*managers over the **Property.***

If

*the **Property** is*

mismanaged,

Our

Spirit

gives notice and withholds all further payments

of

Inspiration, Motivation, Stimulation & Creativity...

If

there are no improvements

in our methods of management,

Our

Spirit

moves away...

leaving no forwarding address,

*and the **Property***

is left

Unattended, Abandon, Neglected, Forsaken

and eventually

Condemned...

In the meantime

Our

Spirit

finds a more worthy place to reside.

...by the way,

what's the condition

*of the **Property***

in which you manage?

Jealous Of You

*Though we have only **just met**, yet,
it has been **brought to my attention**, via a coy mention,
that you have **brought about some dissention**.
There seems to be some **jealousy** in the air—everywhere...
and just between you and me,
I was told it was **brought about by your egocentricity**.
But hold on, before you **lose your humanity**,
I spoke up for thee,
I said, “**How could that be?**”
knowing that **you’re filled** with such **humility**.
So, I made a **plea on behalf** of your **decency**,
stating, that you would not cause such a thing intentionally.
But, my **plea** was only met with more **envy**,
though the **charge** wasn’t made by an **enemy**,
but, by **our own star**, the **Sun**,
our **Solar System’s** only one...
He claims you violated his **copyright**
and that **he’s** the **true author of light!**
And as **proof** he offered this statement as truth,
“**Everyone enjoys having fun in the Sun.**”
Making him **wonder**, where in the hell did you come from?
With your **long silky hair**, highlights shimmering in the air, **making**
people stare...
With your **beautiful brown eyes** twinkling like*

stars in the night skies...

*With your **spirit** so **alive** and a **mind***

*so **brilliant** and **wise**...*

*With your **bright smile** and **irradiating style**...*

*Causing **people** to **forget** for a while who was **first** to bring **light** to
Earth.*

*He's seen your **personality light up a room**,
and **fears** that **people** will soon be **calling on you** to remove their
gloom and **burn-off** the **hazy clouds**
in the afternoon...*

*Then, what **role** would there be for **him** to **assume**?*

*Will he be **reduced** to just **illuminating the moon**?*

*What would he do if you decided
to take over **photosynthesis** too?*

*It's truly coming to **light** that the **Sun** is simply
Jealous Of You.*

*So **darling** please,
now that you've **brought** the **Sun** to **his knees**,
give him a **reprieve**...*

*I don't want to preach to you; however, I do beseech you
to **let him off easy** with **no enmity**
and let him know
that you intend **no threat** to **his superiority**
and **won't challenge his** lustrous **monopoly**,
he truly means no harm you see, just a tab bit of **jealousy**
and maybe a little **insecurity**.*

R. Ray Barnes

*But I am not without **sympathy** for what you've
done to the **Sun**,
Because I woke up this morning not looking for
"his sunshine"
But with the "**light of you**" on my **mind**...*

Just Time Enough

*What is this **Space**...?*

*What is this **Feeling**...?*

*What is this **Moment**...?*

*What is this **Now**...?*

That by the time we figure out what it is

*The **Space** has vanished...*

*The **Feeling** has gone...*

*The **Moment** has past...*

*The **Now** has become history...*

*Sometimes there's not time enough for **Questions***

Just Time Enough

for

Action!

Let Love Be Free

If you want more

Love

in your life, stop trying to put

Handcuffs

on it attempting to

Arrest

it,



Let Love Be Free...

And if

Love

finds you worthy, it will

Arrest

You

Lost In Space

*She has brand new kitchen gadgets
that she rarely uses
that just sits on the counter
taking up space...*

*She has brand new exercise equipment
that she rarely uses
that just sits in the garage
taking up space...*

*She has brand new clothes
that she rarely wears
that just sits in the closet
taking up space...*

*She has a head full of brand new thoughts
that she rarely infuses
that just sits in her mind
taking up space...*

*She has a husband that she shares a bed
that she rarely speaks to
that just sits on the mattress
taking up space...*

*She watches lots of movies and TV shows
that she really seems to enjoy
maybe one of them is
Lost In Space*

Love Garden

*Love is like a **Weed**, it will **Grow Anywhere...***

and

*once it **Takes Root**, it **Easily Spreads**,*

and

*Love can even **Resist Herbicides and Pesticides***

and

*can become very **Difficult to Do Away With.***

*Love is like a **Weed**, it will **Grow Anywhere...***

and

*Love can even **Resist Negativity and Pessimist**,*

so,

*may we all continue to **Plant Seeds** in our **Gardens of Love***



Love Is

Love Is...

Joy & Sorrow

Peace & Unrest

Happiness & Sadness

Tears & Laughter

Smiles & Frowns

Harmony & Discord

all manifesting in a wonderful dance of

Life

Love Is...

*all our **Emotions** coming together as **One**,*

*with each **Emotion** needing its **Opposite** to*

understand and appreciate its own being...

Love Is Every Emotion—Love Is None...

Love Is...

*truly what **you** make of it*

*and what **it** makes of you.*

Love Is Always & Forever

Love Is** what **Love Is...

*You can't
fall in-to love,
nor can you
fall out-of love—*

Love Is Always & Forever Love...

*So don't hope to
fall in-to love,
hope to be-come love...*

*Then **Love** will
fall out-of you,
in abundance—*



Love Is Coming

Love is Coming...

the

Coming of Love

is what everyone

is waiting for...

Love is Coming...

but is

"Cum~~ing~~" Love?

that's the question...

if

Love is Coming...

then is

"Love" Cum~~ing~~...?

Ssssssss

Ahhhhh...

i think

Love Came

Love Is Like A Butterfly

*Just **trust** in **Love***

And don't ask why---

*And **stop** trying to separate the **sun***

*From the other **stars** in the **sky**.*

*Your **heart** bleeds **Love***

And you can't deny,

*Cause I'm **blinded** by the gleam*

*That's always in your **eye***

***Love** is not about **you**,*

*Nor is it about **me**,*

Love** is just **fulfilling

Its own need to be---

*So don't cage **Love** in*

*Just let it **fly free***

*And it'll carry your **spirit***

*On a **journey** to **ecstasy**...*

*Don't try to **read** between the lines*

*And don't over **analyze** it in your **mind**,*

Don't call Psychics on the phone

And don't invite clairvoyants into your home,

Don't try to get your doctor to explain it,

Don't try to rename it or disclaim it...

R. Ray Barnes

*Just **trust** in **Love** and don't ask why---*

*And don't try to **capture***

*All the **rainbows** in the **sky***

*Just set **Love** **free** to **soar high**...*

Cause just like you

Love Is A Butterfly



Love Remains The Same #1

*everything must change,
and does—
except for
Love...
Love...
is forever constant and always
Remains The Same*

Love Remains The Same #2

*Love remains the same
no matter your “point of view”
it’s only what’s in
your Heart
that makes
Love appear different to you...*

Love Will Find You

Stop Looking For

Love

In

All

The

Wrong

Places...

If

Love

Finds

You

Worthy,

No Matter Where You Are

Love

Will

Find

You.

Love's Harvest

*If you don't plant the seeds
of
Sincere Love,
Mutual Respect,
Good Communication,
Understanding, Honesty & Trust
in the
Spring
of your relationship...*

*Don't expect to harvest
Sweet,
Juicy,
Delicious,
Flavor Filled,
Long Lasting & Sincere Love
in the
Fall.*

May I Have This Dance?

You

Danced, Pranced, and Waltzed

Your way into to my life.

So easy and fluent were your moves—

*Like a **Jazz** step,*

So cool, so rhythmic, so smooth...

Then with a picture you smiled at me,

With such glee, so fancy free,

*Like a **Pirouette**,*

I felt your spirit spinning inside of me...

So, we talked,

*As you **Crip Walked** and did **Somersaults** on my mind,*

You were so sweet, so kind—

*You **Tapped** a love beat ever so lightly into my soul,*

Yet so bold were the stories you told...

*Then with a **Lindy Hop***

You put a dip in your hip then

***Be-bopped** and **Pop-locked** your spirit into my heart,*

Now I can't stop thinking about you...

So now there's nothing else for me to do

but ask you,

“May I Have This Dance...?”

Mere Words...

I've seen

Attractive, Pretty, and Beautiful...

*But Mere Words can't describe
what I see*

When I Look At You

I've had

Fun, Excitement and Good Times...

*But Mere Words can't describe
the times I have*

When I'm With You

I've felt

Pleasure, Joy, and Happiness...

*But Mere Words can't describe
what I feel*

When I'm Touched By You

I've been

Intimate, Had Sex and Made Love...

*But Mere Words can't describe
the ecstasy*

When I'm One With You

I've experienced

Quiet Times, Silence, and Peace...

*But only **God** can describe*

*the **sights**, the **times**, the **feelings**, the **ecstasy**, the **sounds***

that I've experienced while

Being In Love With You

Mouth-To-Month Resuscitation

*I was eavesdropping on myself
and realized to my own surprise
My Love was sinking deeper and deeper
into a sea of non-commitment.
I found myself all alone in a cyclone
with no lifesaving equipment
Slowly drowning trying to atone
while calling 911 on the phone.
Upon closer examination without reservation
my situation called for an emergency operation...
There was an echo in the upper chambers of my heart,
the contents completely torn apart
and went missing---
I could hear my heart's breath hissing
as it escaped through my mind's ear
but lodged itself securely in my
Love's fear...
So many stories of Love in my head,
in between sheets and spread across different beds...
But unheard, not a word, so absurd,
my memories are too blurred---
Just untold and left in the fold
until thoughts of them just grew too old.
But lately true Love's been beating strange rhythms*

on my right ear-drum
left me wondering whether there was a song to come
beating so loud I could hear
no melody, no chords, no harmony...
Just an out-of-tune symphony,
or maybe it was just me?
But it sounded terribly wrong,
no tempo, no flow just a misplaced gong...
Nothing I could groove to, make a move to
until you came along
Singing a quiet storm Love song
that marched on & on to a different beat
so soft and so sweet
like a male canary when he tweets...
Then as if in a moment of utter bliss
my head you did twist
and planted upon my lips a tender honeysuckle kiss
that caused our souls to enlist,
Mouth-to-Mouth we couldn't resist,
we rose together from the abyss
Ascending high in the air like clouds in the mist,
and soon thereafter a downpour of Love did persist...
For forty days and forty nights
inside of pure Love we did coexist...
wow, I wonder if heaven feels like this?
So elated,

*I could **feel** my **desire** for true **Love** elevated,
I would have never **anticipated** it,
Love...I always **underestimated** it.
I thought people **overrated** it,
Inflated it, somewhat **overstated** it.
But now that you've come, **proof positive**,
I should've never **negated** it,
in hindsight,
Love... I wish I would've **appreciated** it...
However, because of you,
I do **understand** it's **true** that **patience** is truly a virtue.
My time for **Love** has arrived
and in **your eyes** it's been realized,
I've finally won **Love's prize**...
now **my heart** survives and thrives,
But **I take no credit** in being revived,
it was your **Mouth-to-Mouth**
that kept my **Love** alive...*

M-O-V-I-N-G

M-O-V-I-N-G

M-O-V-I-N-G

M-O-V-I-N-G

in the right direction

75

My Favorite Pastime

*A thought of you is Tap Dancing
ever so lightly
in the corner my mind...*

*I can feel you Tip-Toeing
through the hidden recesses of my heart
playing hide and seek...*

*I can taste your spirit as it Glides Along
so slippery wet upon my lips...*

*I can see you frolicking in my minds' eye
Showing Me moving pictures
of heartwarming stories of love...*

*I can hear the smooth rhythmic melody of your soul
Beating Softly
as it gently caresses my ear-drum...*

*I can smell the sensuously sweet honeysuckle
Aroma Therapy
that emanates from your love...*

R. Ray Barnes

Just A Thought Of You

always makes me feel

so-oh good...

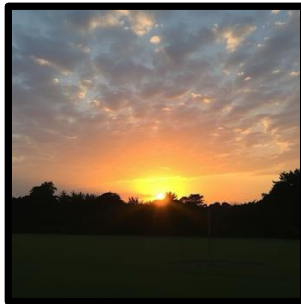
now

thinking of you has become

My Favorite Pastime!

New Day

*It's dusk...
the **new day** is coming
& the coming
new day will be
filled with
joy & love.
love & joy
will be
the essence of
the **new day.**
the coming
new day is
here
for me
now!*



Nothing More Beautiful

if

the

Creator

has made

anything

More Beautiful

than

You—

—She

has

yet

to

reveal

it...

On A Road To Love

*My **Spirit** met your **Spirit** traveling*

On A Road To Love...

*and there was an instant reaction, a special attraction,
that my **Heart** seems to adore
that I've never felt before.*

*Two **Souls** seeking their mates,
full of **Love** without hate,
though patient but can't wait...*

*With anticipation and guarded elation
for what seems to be a wonderful foundation
hoping to build a beautiful **Love** relation...*

*So we jumped about it, danced, and shouted
in celebration and cheer for what seems so near,
while being afraid to unmask our fear
as our eyes tell of old stories of past worries
our hearts seek to discover **Love's** new glory.*

*With a smile, a glance
and a few words
we were smitten,
As our **Spirits** dance to the rhythm
of a **Love** song unwritten...*

R. Ray Barnes

A melody so sweet, if only we can find the beat.

Will it be trick or treat or a challenge?

*or will the scales of **Love** weigh in our balance?*

In time we shall know,

but I pray the journey be swift yet slow

as our hearts ebb and flow

enjoying each moment as we go,

*like slow dancing to **Jazz** under a full moon's glow.*

*My **Spirit** met your **Spirit** traveling*

On A Road To Love...

and there was an instant reaction, a special attraction,

*that my **Heart** seems to adore*

that I've never felt before.

One Less Breath

We must learn

to get the

*Most out of **Life***

NOW!

*Because **Death***

is just

One Less Breath

AWAY...

Relationships Are Like Butterflies

*Relationships are like **Butterflies**...*

*and like **caterpillars** you **crawl, stall**—*

taking it slow, getting to know

one another...

Then,

*once you find **love** you **soar, explore**—*

flying high, asking why of

one another...

Then

*you **cruise**, so **amused**—*

laughing at the ground below

and jesting at the sky above...

realizing that in

Love

there's nothing below and nothing above...

there's just

Love

Sights, Sounds And Feelings Of A Broken Heart

*Broken,
Cracked, Splattered,
Smashed, Crushed, Torn Apart,
Frayed, Tattered, Worn Out, Ragged,
Ripped To Shreds, Sad, Disappointed, Unappreciated, Terrified,
Angry, Mad, Whack, Punked, Hurt, Bruised, Abused, Misused,
Dazed and Confused, Foolish,
Angst, Nervous, Worry, Fear, Pain,
Paranoia, Dumb, Stupid
and just plain ole
Fucked-up!!!
I was trying to describe the
Sights, Sounds and Feelings Of A Broken Heart,
however,
I just couldn't
find the right words...*

Smiling Like Clowns

*Just thoughts of you
Swirling through my head,
As I lie here in bed, nothing said,
Just imagining that your panties are red---Hot!
Midnight's just a few minutes ahead, but I can't stop---
So I just keep thinking instead...
Just thoughts... Wonderful thoughts,
Playful thoughts, Romantic thoughts,
Lovely thoughts & Naughty thoughts too
About Me and You...
I'm having Ultra HD, Wide Screen, Night Visions of
Me and You and You and Me and Me and You
And You and Me and Me and You and You and Me ,
In "Real" 3D
Yearning to be free to live our lives in ecstasy...
Going here, going there, going everywhere!
Without a care, only aware of each other,
No despair—as I get lost playing in your hair...
People stare at our love uncovered,
Unashamed, never casting fought or blame
We just go on to discover more to love about one another.
You are oh so beautiful to me...
From inside-out to outside-in,
To backside-up to upside-down*

*As we **merry-go-round** in love again-and-again...*

*Going **sideways-front to sideways-back**,*

Riding on love tracks

*Going way **beyond friends** as we rise*

*We chose so **wise** our **love** is just the **right size***

*It's no **surprise** we wear **no disguise***

*Looking into each other's **eyes** we **realize***

*That what's been **lost** in each of us has now been **found**,*

***Ascending** from aground like steam from a geyser*

*Yes! We're headed **upward** bound*

*Being **bombarded** with **sensuous sounds***

*As we pass through **unconditional**,*

***Infinite love** in the atmosphere*

*Just floating around, I see **no frowns**, cause we're just*

Smiling Like Clowns



So, The Question Is

So, the question is...

*I **Woke Up** this Morning*

*To the **Thought** of your **Love***

*To the **Light** of your **Smile***

*To the **Feel** of your **Touch***

*To the **Taste** of your **Kiss***

*To the **Sounds** of your **Laughter***

*To the **Smell** of your **Spirit***

*To the **Warmth** of your **Heart***

*To the **Essence** of your **Being***

*And it **Made My Nature Rise...***

*You know, Like the **Sun Rises***

*Like a **Ballpark Frank** when you cook it*

*Like a loaf of **Fresh Bread** in the oven*

*Like a bag of **Microwave Popcorn***

*Like a **Balloon** when you blow it up*

*Like a **Home Run** hit by Barry Bonds*

*Like a deep **Touchdown Pass** thrown by Tom Brady*

*Like a **Three Point Shot** by **Stephan Curry...***

Wait-a-minute—hold up!

Let's just stop with all this

Romantic Poetic Bullshit!!!

Cause you know what,

in reality,

*When I **Woke Up** this Morning...*

*the **Thought**, the **Light**, the **Feel**, the **Taste**, the **Sounds**,*

*the **Smell**, the **Warmth**, and the **Essence** of your **Being***

really just

Made My Dick



Hard...

*So, the **Real** question is...*

What

The

Fuck

are you going to do about it?

Something So Special About You

There is
Something So Special
About You,
a smile, a laugh, a whisper, a touch...
Something I've
*never **seen**, never **heard** of, never **felt**,*
yet seems so familiar to me...
Something
intriguing and mystifying,
yet so
satisfying, gratifying, and un-denying...
*It's **Something...***
*a **gift**, a **treasure**, a **brilliance**,*
*a **love**---that's simply you...*
yeah,
There is
Something So Special
About You!
...and I think everyone knows it too!

Sparkle & Shine

*When searching for **Love** don't become blinded by the*

Sparkle & Shine...

Keep in mind, it's easy to find

Cubic Zirconium

without a mine shaft or a spike

you can manufacture as much as you like.

And though it has a brilliant

Sparkle & Shine,

and physical bluster, eventually it loses its luster.

causing many to opine that in time

it has very little value and there's

no

"one of a kind."

But it's factual

*that **Diamonds** are rare and occur natural*

deep within the Earth's core,

and you must work harder if you want more.

Diamonds are

Hard to Find,

Hard to Reach

and

Hard to Mine...

and though

R. Ray Barnes

Prized, Precious and extremely Valuable,

Diamonds are not easily recognizable

in their natural state.

It takes a very discerning eye—one must be patient...

and though difficult to unearth, obtain, and secure,

*once acquired, **Diamonds** forever endure...*

and will always

Sparkle & Shine

and increase in value over time.

*So, when searching for **Love** seek **Diamonds**,*

“One of a kind,”

not those who just

Sparkle & Shine...

Sun-Flower

How will I know her?

*I will know **Her** because...*

She will be Beautiful

*Like a **Flower**,*

Like an April Shower,

*Like **Her** Spirit—**Beautiful**,*

*Like **Her** Smile—**Beautiful**...*

She will be Colorful

*Like a **Flower**,*

Like a Rainbow,

*Like **Her** Personality—**Colorful**,*

*Like **Her** Style—**Colorful**...*

She will be Soft & Gentle

*Like a **Flower**,*

Like an Angel,

*Like **Her** Heart—**Soft & Gentle**,*

*Like **Her** Touch—**Soft & Gentle**...*

She will be Illuminating

*Like the **Sun**,*

Like the Moon,

*Like **Her** Eyes—**Illuminating**,*

*Like **Her** Thoughts—**Illuminating**...*

She will be Hot

Like the Sun,
Like Fire,
Like Her Passion—Hot,
Like Her Desire—Hot...

She will be Life-giving

Like the Sun,
Like the Earth,
Like Her Love—Life-giving,
Like Her Soul—Life-giving...

So, you see,

I will know Her because...

She will be Illuminating,

Hot & Life-giving

Like the Sun...

She will be Beautiful,

Colorful,

Soft & Gentle

Like a Flower...

and

I will know Her because...

She will be My Sun-Flower

That Night

*It was a gentle embrace that set the pace
as our hearts gave chase to a romantic flight.
We talked and we shared, we listened and cared
sincerely about each other's plight...
Your warm heart set you apart and right from the start
you gave warmth to the chill in the air.
As I looked into your eyes there's no way I could disguise
how your spirit had touched me everywhere...
A beautiful sight you were, and like a kitten you purred,
as I felt your soul stirring softly next to mine.
So delightful was **That Night** as our hearts took flight
both hoping sweet love we'd find...
Though the sky was midnight blue, after kissing you
we grooved and were seduced by Al Green.
I really didn't want to mention
that you brought me to attention
but I knew we needed desperately to change the scene...
So we retreated and resealed as the kisses were repeated
you truly brought me down to my knees,
My tongue began to tingle as our bodies began to mingle
and your love was now feeling the breeze...
Your love I did tease, had you shaking like leaves
feeling the chills and thrills of my love,
But you held on tight to my love all night*

R. Ray Barnes

*as we lay snug like a hand in glove...
There was ecstasy and pleasure way beyond measure
as we both seemed to hit the right spot,
And though I was on top with passion sizzling hot
I kissed your breast and thought it best that we stop...
Didn't feel a need to rush so we both offered a blush
knowing that we would come in love again,
It was a night to remember
like a Christmas day in December
our romantic star was truly shining bright
That Night...
An odyssey did begin of true love and best friends
and I pray that our journey of joy never ends...*

The Complaint Department

SHE

*expresses little knowledge
about what*

SHE

wants,

or

truly needs...



But,

SHE

complains vociferously about what

SHE

doesn't have...

The Cost

I woke up this morning thinking about

The Cost

we pay for things ...

*The first thing I usually do is reach for my glasses,
Yves Saint Laurent frames with transition lenses, you know the one's
that darken in the light and lighten in the dark.*

Of course they had the anti-glare coating.

The Cost

was \$485.00 at Costco.

*Then I reached for the remote control to my
75-inch Sony 4K Ultra HD Smart LED TV
so I can keep abreast and stay informed
as it regards today's world events.*

The Cost

*Was \$1,899.00. However, I only paid \$1,299.00
after the price was reduced \$500.00 along with an additional \$100.00
special manufacturer's discount given at the time of purchase.*

*Next, I headed to the bathroom to relieve myself of the water that had
built up in my bladder overnight.*

*Washed my hands and proceeded to grab my Braun Oral B iO Series
7c Rechargeable Toothbrush.*

No, I know what you're thinking, that 7 Series sounded like a BMW. I wish. But it's just an electric toothbrush.

The Cost

Was \$299.99 for a 2-pack on sale at Costco.

As I stepped into the shower I reached for my multiple position pulsating Waterpik Shower Massager

The Cost

Was only \$59.99 with a coupon I had from Costco.

Yeah, that's right, I love me some Costco.

Then I began to get dressed. Today it was just casual, so I threw on some jeans and a tee shirt.

The Cost

Was \$240.00 for the Ed Hardy jeans along with a \$120.00 for the matching Ed Hardy tee shirt.

Of course, I didn't pay \$360.00 for a pair a blue jeans and a damn tee shirt. I got the shit wholesale.

I added to it a pair of black Kenneth Cole half boots.

The Cost

Was \$125.00 on sale at Macy's.

I left my modest 2 bedroom, 2 bath apartment in the suburbs of Los Angeles.

*You know, one of those old apartments with the old harvest gold built-
in ovens and countertop range
that use to be the shit back in the thirties.*

The Price

*The apartment goes for is about \$1,800.00 a month, but I don't pay
that because I've been there so damn long.*

*Now, where I'd really like to live is in an estate with a tennis court that
overlooks the city
and maybe even has a view of the ocean.*

*I saw one in the real estate section of the newspaper,
and they described it like this:*

*"Amazing Malibu Beach estate with 6 Bedrooms + Den, 7.5 baths. It
is 6.5 acres on a bluff overlooking the beautiful La Costa Beach. This
estate has a tennis court on site and access to a private beach from
La Costa Beach Club."*

The Cost

*Was a measly 15 Million US dollars, not Pesos!
And it didn't even have the city view I wanted.*

*I stopped by a newsstand to buy me a lotto ticket so I could win the
money I needed to buy my estate and my Bentley and saw a magazine
cover that had a beautiful picture of Halle Berry on it. It mentioned
that her talent fetched quite a bit per film after having won the
Academy Award.*

The Cost

15 million.

It made me think, if Halle's talent is worth 15 million

what might my girl's love be worth?

*She's 5'7" with a caramel colored complexion, beautiful smile, pretty
brown eyes, nice legs, long hair, sensuous, sexy, gorgeous, pleasing
personality, intelligent, knowledgeable, creative, loving, caring,
sensitive, kindhearted and has a great sense of humor...*

*But after thinking about it, with all she has to offer and what she
means to me, I realize*

The Cost

For her love is...

Priceless

The Me Too Movement

A

Beautiful Black Lady

*saw **Me** standing on the corner*

*and asked **Me**...*

“Do you need a ride somewhere?”

And I replied,

“Yes!”

She said,

“Which way are you going?”

And I said,

“Up...”

She responded,

“Me Too!”



me too.

The Time Is Now

The Time Is Now

*To make a new start,
Let **love** guide your **heart from above**...
Don't worry how just let go of your fear
Your **heart** is so near to **true love***

The Time Is Now

*You've come this far
So just follow that **star from above**
Don't worry how just don't look back
And stay on the track to **my love***

The Time Is Now

*Your **love** will take flight
Just trust in the **light from above**
Don't worry how they're no answers to find
It's all so **divine our love***



There Is A Sweetness About You

There is a

Sweetness About You...

*that oozes into my system and coats the bottom of my soul
whenever i close my eyes and open my heart to your*

Love—

There is a

Sweetness About You...

*whose syrupy liquid droplets beats sugary rhythms
on my ear drums
whenever you whisper your words of*

Love—

There is a

Sweetness About You...

*that's red hot and drips and drips and drips
from your fingertips branding me
whenever you touch me with your*

Love—

There is a

Sweetness About You...

*that engulfs me, grabs hold of me,
picks me up and body slams me
right into the depths of my emotions
whenever you caress me with your*

Love—

There is a

Sweetness About You...

that makes my mouth water, my lips drool,

my tongue perspire

in anticipation of the wet juicy kisses that

comes from your

Love—

There is a

Sweetness About You...

that nourishes like papayas, like mangos,

like pineapples, like coconuts, like bananas,

like naseberries, like star apples, like black cherries

whenever I taste the fruits of your

Love—

There is a

Sweetness About You...

that thrills, feels, chills, heals and re-veals my heart

whenever you re-fill my prescription with your

Love—

There is a

Sweetness About You...

that fully surrounds me, like my aura,

like my spirit, like my god,

making me feel so good

whenever you look, whisper, touch, caress, kiss, nourish

or fill me up with your

R. Ray Barnes

Love—

yes!

There is a

Sweetness About You...

and damn,

*I sure hope I'm not **diabetic**...*

There Is Nothing More Beautiful

There Was A Time

*when i would awake—
at the dawn's earliest light,
just to see the breathtaking **beauty of the sun**
as it slowly rises—sneaking up behind miss mountain
and gently tapping her on the shoulder good morning...*

There Was A Time

*when i would drive—
for days to get far enough away from the city lights,
just so i could gaze at the humbling **beauty of the stars**
as they glisten like diamond adorned chandeliers hanging
high on the ceiling of God's living room...*

There Was A Time

*when i would hike—
for hours to reach that special place in the forest,
just so i could observe
the majestic **beauty of the gigantic redwoods**
as they command you to look up in awe of them...*

There Was A Time

*when i would rush—
to be the first one on the plain after a big snow fall,
just so i could witness the pure white, untouched, crystalline
beauty of freshly fallen snow...*

There Was A Time

when i would travel—

for miles in autumn to reach Anganguero, Mexico

just so i could be among the first

to catch a glimpse of the awesome

beauty of the gathering of

millions of Monarch Butterflies...

There Was A Time

when i would swim—

into a maze of coral, in the tranquil waters

of Australia's Great Barrier Reef,

just so i could feast my eyes upon

the amazing array of colors

that greet you when you're swimming

in the wellspring of God...

There Was A Time

when i would set sail—

and venture far away to the island paradise of Jamaica,

just so i could set my eyes upon

the magnificent beauty of her world renown, awe-inspiring sunsets...

but now,

Since We've Been Together...

when i want to see—

the beauty of a sunrise at dawn,

the beauty of the stars glistening at night,

*the beauty of a forest of gigantic Redwoods,
the beauty of freshly fallen snow on the plain,
the beauty of millions of Monarch Butterflies,
the beauty of a maze of coral in the wellspring of God,
the beauty of a magnificent sunset...*

*i just have to—
wake-up, look into your eyes,
and see you smile,
because of all the beauty that i have seen*

*There Is Nothing More Beautiful
than You...*

What Love Is?

*Oh how you **Touch** me, **Caress** me,
and **Fill** me up with your **Love**...
Such a **Wonderful Spirit** you are.
A **Bright Light** shining through me—
Illuminating the deep dark corners
of my **Love** starved **Soul**.*

*I **Thank God** for your **Light of Love**.
Like the warm early morning sun, a moist afternoon shower
and a sensuous moonlit night,
I **Feel** you energizing and nourishing me,
fulfilling my **Need** for **Romance**,
feeding my hunger and quenching
my **Thirst** for **Love** and my **Desire** to be **Loved**...*

*You've **Choreographed** in me a new **Dance of Life**,
Reborn as
A **Waltz of Love**, A **Ballet of Joy**, A **Salsa of Pleasure**,
A **Tango of Growth**, A **Modern Miracle of Trust**,
as you so **Rhythmically** and so softly
Tapped your way into my heart...*

*Now, whenever I **Feel** the **Music of Love***

***Dancing** inside of me,*

*it's your sweet **Melody**, your kind **Heart**,*

*your loving **Soul**, your giving **Spirit***

***Blending** in such beautiful **Harmony**...*

It's you that comes to mind—because

Y-O-U

are

What Love Is

What Music Is

Music is what it is,

Music does what it does,

Music is what it does,

Music does what it is ...

Music is loud and it's quiet,

can vicious and non-violent,

put you in a cold sweat and make you hot!

it's the rhythm of your heartbeat keeping you alive or not...

Music is what it is.

Music is a lifesaver for many,

can't overdose even if you've had plenty,

can relieve and unleash misery,

yet it's safe, all natural, and drug free...

Music does what it does.

Music abounds, astounds, and surrounds,

make you get up and get down,

have you shaking yo' ass and dance,

enhancing your chance for romance...

Music is what it does.

Music can rearrange your mind,

have you losing all track of time,

make you get a-head if you're inclined,

pushing you fast-forward while shaking your behind...

Music does what it is

With Rhythm

Music can simplify the complicated,
bring you joy when you're frustrated,
make your enemies feel related,
check your ego when you're overrated...

Music is what it is.

Music can bring inspiration and hope,
make you feel higher than dope,
can be obnoxious or barely heard,
be the sweetest melody or bitterly sung words...

Music does what it does.

Music can make your heart and mind elated,
open wide that which was gated,
give you strength when you're over-weighted,
make you feel current when you're outdated...

Music is what it does.

Music when use as directed
brings joy to those neglected
is an all-natural prescription,
that puts sadness in re-mission...

Music does what it is

With Melody

Music can put you in a trance,
and enhance your circumstance,
makes you move in ways unexpected,
and bring acceptance to those rejected...

Music is what it is.

***Music can make you love that which you hated,
bring joy when you're frustrated,
and may make you take a chance
at bringing about romance...***

Music does what it does.

***Music can be quite insightful,
very pleasing and delightful,
make you move when you didn't plan to
affect your mind like good voodoo...***

Music is what it does.

***Music should never be rejected,
ignored or disrespected,
cause it has a way of touching hearts
that brings together that which was apart...***

Music does what it is

In Harmony

When It's Time

*Her skin is smooth as silk
Her touch is like that of satin
She exudes so much class
In my dreams she speaks in Latin...*

*She showers me with her beauty
Such a treat for my sore eyes
I truly believe she's an Angel
Just captured in human disguise...*

*How colorful and bright her spirit
To see her gives meaning to sight
And the way her eyes seem to sparkle
You would think them to be love's guiding light...*

*I'm moved by her queenly majesty
I'm held still by her charm and grace
From her heart oozes the sweetest of honey
And her love I can almost taste...
She's such a special lady
And I hardly even know her name
Though she truly is just a stranger
I feel love for her just the same...
I have no expectations*

R. Ray Barnes

Only my joy I hope to share

and

When It's Time For Love To Call My Name,

I only hope that she'd be there...

When Love Hurts

When Love Hurts...how do you feel it?

Do you feel it with every beat of your heart?

Do you feel it in the depths of your soul?

Do you feel it in the springtime of love's blossoming?

Do you feel it in the winter when love's grown old?

When Love Hurts...how do you feel it?

Do you feel it in your togetherness?

Do you feel it when you're all alone?

Does it pain you to the core of your life-force?

Does it cause you to weep and moan?

When Love Hurts...how do you feel it?

Does it haunt you into nightmares?

Does it darken your brightest daydreams?

Does it discolor your aura?

Does it make your spirit scream?

When Love Hurts...how do you feel it?

Does it make you feel abandon?

Do you feel empty, broken, and cold?

Does it make you feel poor inside,

When you know your heart is filled with gold?

When Love Hurts...how do you feel it?

R. Ray Barnes

It's mystery I will reveal
For in truth, it feels like none of the above,
Because
Love
doesn't hurt,
it
only heals...



You

*When I look into the mirror
It's Your smile that I see there,
When I'm groping for deeper meaning
I feel Your presence everywhere,
When I'm reaching for my higher self
It's Your spirit that lifts me up,
When I'm thirsting for a greater purpose
Your wisdom fills my cup,
When I'm feeling desperate and anxious
Your peaceful nature keeps me sound,
When I need to be uplifted
Your joy never lets me down,
When I'm seeking understanding
You sincerely understand my quest,
When I ask for knowledge of self
It's You who knows me best,
When I'm feeling sad and alone
Your soul seems perpetually near,,
When I'm craving for lust and passion
You so lustfully appear,
When I'm longing for rest and comfort
Your heart is my easy chair,*

R. Ray Barnes

*When I desire to be truly loved
There is no mistaking that **You** care.
When I think of being in heaven
It may seem strange but it's true,
My thoughts of heavenly bliss
All begin and end with **You**...*

You Make Me Wanna

You Make Me Wanna

*Smile at everything,
Laugh until I cry,
And cry until I sigh never asking why...*

You Make Me Wanna

*Hold you all night,
Caress your body tight,
While surrounding your Spirit with my light...*

You Make Me Wanna

*Dance all the time,
Like I've totally lost my mind,
With no reason and no rhyme,
Just so happy that you're mine...*

You Make Me Wanna

*Scream and Shout your name,
Like I'm damn near insane,
Just so very glad you came,
Knowing now my life will never be the same...*

You Make Me Wanna

*Talk about you the whole day through,
Make a list of all that you do
That makes my dream of loving you come true...*

R. Ray Barnes

You Make Me Wanna

Write you a love song,

Then serenade you all night long,

While we make love until the cows come home...

You Make Me Wanna

Love you and be true,

With Me loving only You,

The way that love is supposed to make you do...

You Make Me Wanna

Love you deeply from the start,

Keep you forever in my heart,

So close that we could never part...

You Make Me Wanna

Live all the love I have,

You Make Me Wanna

Give all the love I have,

You Make Me Wanna

Be the best that I can be,

You Make Me Wanna

Love you infinitely! girl,

You Just Make Me Wanna...

Just Make Me Wanna...

But what's more,

I'm Gonna!

Your Life Has No Sequel

Your Life Has No Sequel

No equal—

No re-takes—No re-makes

No re-runs—No if-comes

No maybe's

No prostitutes—No ladies

No righteous ones

No illegitimate babies—No ego to drive you crazy...

Your Life Has No Sequel

No equal—

No claims—No games

No dreams—No get rich schemes

No pauses—No just causes

No rewind—No fast-forward

No steady flow—No advance-to-go

and collect two hundred dollars

No one to hear you scream when you holler

No fame in your name—No cocaine to ease your pain

No scandals to disclaim...

Your Life Has No Sequel

No equal—

No dark —No light

R. Ray Barnes

No day—No night
No Black—No white
No wrong—No right
No up—No down
No scholars—No clowns
No hot—No cold
No young—No old
No heart—No soul...

Your Life Has No Sequel

No equal—
No time to find your mind
and lose it a thousand times
smoking dope and drinking wine
*looking for **Life's** reason and rhyme—*

***Life** has no reason and **Death** is its rhyme*
*so whatever your **Life's** plan*

Now is the Time...

because

Your Life Has No Sequel

